

Foundations of Denoising diffusion probabilistic model

[Denoising diffusion probabilistic model]

1.0 Content Block

To construct a probability path, we start by construct a conditional probability path $p_t(x|z)$ and the corresponding conditional velocity field $v_t(x|z)$ on some conditional distribution $q(z)$. A natural choice is the Gaussian conditional probability path:

2.0 Content Block

Let $x_0, x_t \sim q$, $x_t = \alpha_t x_0 + \sigma_t \epsilon$, $\epsilon \sim q(\cdot|x_t)$. Then the conditional probability path is given by $p_t(x|z) = \mathcal{N}(x_t | \alpha_t x_0 + \sigma_t \epsilon, \sigma_t^2 I)$. The corresponding conditional velocity field is $v_t(x|z) = \frac{1}{\sigma_t} (x_t - \alpha_t x_0)$.

3.0 Content Block

Architectural improvements proposed various architectural improvements. For example, they proposed log-space interpolation during backward sampling. Instead of sampling from $x_{t-1} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_{t-1}(x_t, x_0), \sigma_{t-1}^2 I)$, they recommended sampling from $\mathcal{N}(\mu_{t-1}(x_t, x_0), (\sigma_{t-1}^2 - \sigma_t^2) I)$ for a learned parameter v . In the v -prediction formalism, the noising formula $x_t = \alpha_t x_0 + \sigma_t \epsilon$ is reparameterised by an angle ϕ_t such that $\cos \phi_t = \alpha_t$ and a "velocity" defined by $\sin \phi_t = \sigma_t$. The network is trained to predict the velocity $\hat{v}_t$, and denoising is by $x_{\phi_t - \delta} = \cos(\delta) x_{\phi_t} - \sin(\delta) \hat{v}_t$. This parameterization was found to improve performance, as the model can be trained to reach total noise (i.e. $\phi_t = 90^\circ$) and then reverse it, whereas the standard parameterization never reaches total noise since $\alpha_t > 0$ is always true.

4.0 Content Block

Diffusion model For generating images by DDPM, we need a neural network that takes a time t and a noisy image x_t , and predicts a noise $\epsilon_t(x_t, t)$ from it. Since predicting the noise is the same as predicting the denoised image, then subtracting it from x_t , denoising architectures tend to work well. For example, the U-Net, which was found to be good for denoising images, is often used for denoising diffusion models that generate images. For DDPM, the underlying architecture ("backbone") does not have to be a U-Net. It just has to predict the noise somehow. For example, the diffusion transformer (DiT) uses a Transformer to predict the mean and diagonal covariance of the noise, given the textual conditioning and the partially denoised image. It is the same as standard U-Net-based denoising diffusion model, with a Transformer replacing the U-Net. Mixture of experts-Transformer can also be applied. DDPM can be used to model general data distributions, not just natural-looking images. For example, Human Motion Diffusion models human motion trajectory by DDPM. Each human motion trajectory is a sequence of poses, represented by either joint rotations or positions. It uses a Transformer network to generate a less noisy trajectory out of a

noisy one.

5.0 Content Block

$N(\mu, \Sigma)$ is the normal distribution with mean μ and variance Σ , and $N(x|\mu, \Sigma)$ is the probability density at x . A vertical bar denotes conditioning. A forward diffusion process starts at some starting point $x_0 \sim q$, where q is the probability distribution to be learned, then repeatedly adds noise to it by $x_t = \sqrt{1 - \beta_t} x_{t-1} + \sqrt{\beta_t} z_t$ where $z_1, \dots, z_T$ are IID (Independent and identically distributed random variables) samples from $N(0, I)$. The coefficients $\sqrt{1 - \beta_t}$ and $\sqrt{\beta_t}$ ensure that $\text{Var}(X_t) = I$ assuming that $\text{Var}(X_0) = I$. The values of β_t are chosen such that for any starting distribution of x_0 , if it has finite second moment, then $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} x_t | x_0$ converges to $N(0, I)$. The entire diffusion process then satisfies $q(x_0:T) = q(x_0) q(x_1|x_0) \cdots q(x_T|x_{T-1}) = q(x_0) N(x_1|\alpha_1 x_0, \beta_1 I) \cdots N(x_T|\alpha_T x_{T-1}, \beta_T I)$ or $\ln q(x_0:T) = \ln q(x_0) - \sum_{t=1}^T \frac{1}{2\beta_t} \|x_t - \sqrt{1 - \beta_t} x_{t-1}\|^2 + C$ where C is a normalization constant and often omitted. In particular, we note that $x_{1:T}|x_0$ is a Gaussian process, which affords us considerable freedom in reparameterization. For example, by standard manipulation with Gaussian process, $x_t | x_0 \sim N(\alpha_t^{-1} x_0, \sigma_t^2 I)$